

MTUS Analysis Document

MTUS Constitutional Analysis Project
Personal Research Initiative
February 2026

ELBOW DISORDERS GUIDELINE - STATISTICAL ANALYSIS

SOURCE DOCUMENT: ACOEM Elbow Disorders Guideline

EFFECTIVE DATE: July 14, 2025

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FULL TEXT AVAILABLE AT: <https://www.acoem.org/guidelines-resources/library/>

OFFICIAL MTUS ADOPTION: California Code of Regulations, Title 8, Section 9792.20

MTUS REGULATIONS: https://www.dir.ca.gov/dwc/MTUS/MTUS_Regulations.htm

STATISTICAL SUMMARY

TOTAL RECOMMENDATIONS ANALYZED: 205

RECOMMENDATION BREAKDOWN:

Category | Count | Percentage

Strongly Recommended | 3 | 1.5%

Recommended | 12 | 5.9%

Not Recommended | 5 | 2.4%

Insufficient Evidence | 185 | 90.1%

KEY FINDING: 90.1% of all recommendations are "Insufficient Evidence"

HIGHEST DENIAL RATE: Among all guidelines analyzed

FDA-APPROVED TREATMENTS DENIED

The following FDA-approved treatments receive "Insufficient Evidence" ratings:

Medications:

- Topical diclofenac (Voltaren Gel) - FDA approved 2007
- Topical NSAIDs for lateral epicondylalgia
- Platelet-rich plasma (PRP) injections - FDA approved device

Procedures:

- Extracorporeal shock wave therapy (ESWT)
- Autologous blood injection
- Prolotherapy
- Botulinum toxin injections for spasticity

Physical Medicine:

- Laser therapy (Class IV)
- Therapeutic ultrasound (certain indications)
- Dry needling

Note: Full indication details available in official ACOEM guideline at source URL above.

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EVIDENCE QUALITY ANALYSIS

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ACOEM'S STATED METHODOLOGY:

- Requires randomized controlled trials (RCTs) for "Strongly Recommended" status
- Systematic reviews prioritized over individual studies
- Cost-effectiveness analyses incorporated

CRITICAL OBSERVATIONS:

1. 90.1% "Insufficient Evidence" is the HIGHEST rate among all 17 MTUS guidelines
2. Only 1.5% of treatments are "Strongly Recommended"
3. Evidence threshold effectively denies coverage for most conservative treatments

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CONSTITUTIONAL IMPLICATIONS

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This guideline demonstrates the most egregious denial pattern in the MTUS system. With only 1.5% "Strongly Recommended" and 90.1% "Insufficient Evidence," injured workers have virtually no guaranteed access to treatment.

For full legal analysis, see:

- MTUSCONSTITUTIONALVIOLATIONMASTERREPORT.txt
- MTUS14THAMENDMENTLEGALARGUMENTS.txt

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For the complete, official guideline text, visit:
<https://www.acoem.org/guidelines-resources/library/>

This analysis represents the author's independent research and opinions.

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Document prepared: February 2026

Classification: Research Analysis / Commentary

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